

Recruitment Challenge

25 Candidate Resumes

These are the 25 candidates who applied for the Backend Engineer (Python & APIs) role. Your task: read them, compare each against the job description, and recommend the top 5 to interview. Give one line of reasoning for each of your five.

Read the job description alongside this pack. Both are part of the download.

Just Build Foundation · practice material · names and companies are fictional

Aarav Sharma

Senior Backend Engineer

Bengaluru, IN · aaravsharma@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Backend engineer with six years building payment and API services in Python. Owns systems end to end.

SKILLS

Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · AWS · Docker · Kafka · REST

EXPERIENCE

Fintech, Senior Backend Engineer

2021 – present

- Rebuilt the payouts service in Python and cut failures from 2.1% to 0.3%.
- Owns 14 REST APIs on AWS handling 40M+ requests/month.
- Introduced Kafka for settlement events, removing a nightly batch.

E-commerce startup, Backend Engineer

2018 – 2021

- Built order and inventory APIs in Python + PostgreSQL.
- Cut checkout latency 45% with query and caching work.

EDUCATION

B.E. Computer Science, VIT Vellore, 2018

Emily Carter

Backend Engineer

London, UK · emilycarter@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Python backend engineer, five years, strong on APIs, data, and cloud. Ships and owns.

SKILLS

Python · Django · PostgreSQL · GCP · REST · Redis

EXPERIENCE

Logistics scale-up, Backend Engineer

2020 – present

- Designed the pricing API in Django, now core to the product.
- Moved services to GCP, cutting infra spend 30%.
- Mentors two juniors and runs code review.

Agency, Software Engineer

2019 – 2020

- Built client REST APIs in Python.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science, University of Manchester, 2019

Rohan Mehta

Backend Engineer

Pune, IN · rohanmehta@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Four years of hands-on Python backend work with real production ownership and cloud.

SKILLS

Python · Flask · MySQL · AWS · REST · Docker

EXPERIENCE

Healthtech, Backend Engineer

2021 – present

- Built and owns the appointments API in Flask + MySQL.
- Deployed on AWS with Docker; 99.95% uptime over the last year.
- Cut a report job from 40 min to 3 min.

Services firm, Junior Engineer

2020 – 2021

- Python scripting and API glue work.

EDUCATION

B.Tech IT, COEP Pune, 2020

Mei Lin Tan

Senior Software Engineer

Singapore · meilintan@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Seven years across backend Python and data platforms, with clear production impact.

SKILLS

Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · AWS · Kafka · Airflow · REST

EXPERIENCE

Regional bank, Senior Engineer

2019 – present

- Leads the transactions API platform in Python on AWS.
- Cut fraud-check latency from 800ms to 120ms.
- Owns data pipelines feeding the risk team.

Fintech, Backend Engineer

2016 – 2019

- Built settlement APIs and reporting.

EDUCATION

BSc Computing, NUS, 2016

Daniel Okafor

Backend Engineer

Lagos, NG · danielokafor@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Five years building reliable Python APIs for high-volume consumer apps, cloud-native.

SKILLS

Python · Django · PostgreSQL · Azure · REST · Docker

EXPERIENCE

Mobile payments company, Backend Engineer

2020 – present

- Owns the wallet API in Django on Azure, 12M users.
- Reduced timeouts 60% with connection pooling and indexing.
- Set up the CI pipeline the whole team uses.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science, University of Lagos, 2019

Ananya Iyer

Backend Engineer

Chennai, IN · ananyaiyer@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Backend developer, four years, Python and data-heavy APIs with measurable wins.

SKILLS

Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · GCP · REST · Pandas

EXPERIENCE

Analytics SaaS, Backend Engineer

2021 – present

- Built the metrics API in FastAPI + PostgreSQL on GCP.
- Cut dashboard load time 70% by reshaping queries.
- Owns the ingestion service for 3B rows/month.

Startup, Engineer

2020 – 2021

- Python API and ETL work.

EDUCATION

B.E. CSE, Anna University, 2020

Priya Nair

Backend Engineer

Kochi, IN · priyanair@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Strong Python and API engineer. Deep on databases; limited cloud so far.

SKILLS

Python · Flask · PostgreSQL · REST · Redis

EXPERIENCE

SaaS company, Backend Engineer

2020 – present

- Owns the billing API in Flask + PostgreSQL.
- Cut invoice errors 90% with a validation layer.
- On-prem deployment; starting to learn AWS now.

EDUCATION

B.Tech CS, CUSAT, 2020

Carlos Mendoza

Software Engineer

Madrid, ES · carlosmendoza@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Six years in Python, strong impact, but a run of short stints.

SKILLS

Python · FastAPI · MySQL · AWS · REST · Docker

EXPERIENCE

Fintech, Backend Engineer

2023 – present

- Owns two payment APIs on AWS.

Marketplace, Engineer

2022 – 2023

- Built search API in Python.

Adtech, Engineer

2021 – 2022

- REST services in FastAPI.

Agency, Engineer

2018 – 2021

- Python backend for clients.

EDUCATION

MSc Software Engineering, UPM Madrid, 2018

Vikram Reddy

Backend Engineer

Hyderabad, IN · vikramreddy@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Five years Python backend. Very strong build skills, thinner on measurable impact.

SKILLS

Python · Django · PostgreSQL · AWS · REST

EXPERIENCE

Enterprise software, Backend Engineer

2019 – present

- Works on internal APIs in Django on AWS.
- Maintains a large legacy service.
- Part of a ten-person backend team.

EDUCATION

B.Tech CSE, JNTU Hyderabad, 2019

Aisha Abdullah

Backend Engineer

Dubai, AE · aishaabdullah@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Solid Python API engineer with cloud, but no relational database depth (mostly NoSQL).

SKILLS

Python · FastAPI · MongoDB · AWS · REST

EXPERIENCE

Delivery startup, Backend Engineer

2021 – present

- Owns the orders API in FastAPI on AWS.
- Scaled to 2M orders/month.
- Data is all MongoDB; no SQL in this role.

EDUCATION

BSc CS, American University of Sharjah, 2020

Sofia Rossi

Backend Engineer

Milan, IT · sofiarossi@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Five years, strong Python and cloud; most impact numbers are team-level, not owned.

SKILLS

Python · Django · PostgreSQL · GCP · REST · Docker

EXPERIENCE

E-commerce, Backend Engineer

2019 – present

- Part of the team that rebuilt checkout in Python.
- Contributes to APIs on GCP.
- Helped cut latency across the platform.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Engineering, Politecnico di Milano, 2019

Karthik Rao

Backend Engineer

Bengaluru, IN · karthikrao@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Three years, right on the bar. Real Python + cloud, still growing ownership.

SKILLS

Python · Flask · PostgreSQL · AWS · REST

EXPERIENCE

Fintech, Backend Engineer

2021 – present

- Builds and maintains lending APIs in Flask on AWS.
- Cut a nightly job runtime in half.
- Growing into feature ownership.

EDUCATION

B.E. ISE, RVCE Bengaluru, 2021

Neha Gupta

Software Engineer

Delhi, IN · nehagupta@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Two years, capable Python developer, still early on production ownership.

SKILLS

Python · Flask · MySQL · REST

EXPERIENCE

IT services, Software Engineer

2022 – present

- Builds REST APIs in Flask for client projects.
- Some AWS exposure through the team.

EDUCATION

B.Tech CS, DTU Delhi, 2022

Lucas Silva

Backend Developer

Sao Paulo, BR · lucassilva@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Three years Python, mostly internal tools; limited cloud and API scale.

SKILLS

Python · Django · SQLite · REST

EXPERIENCE

Manufacturing firm, Developer

2021 – present

- Builds internal Django tools.
- Small user base; no cloud deployment yet.

EDUCATION

BSc Information Systems, USP, 2021

Fatima Khan

Backend Engineer

Karachi, PK · fatimakhan@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Four years Python and APIs; solid, evidence of impact is modest.

SKILLS

Python · FastAPI · MySQL · AWS · REST

EXPERIENCE

SaaS startup, Backend Engineer

2020 – present

- Maintains customer APIs in FastAPI on AWS.
- Fixed a data bug affecting reports.

EDUCATION

BS Computer Science, NUST, 2020

James Whitfield

Software Engineer

Austin, US · jameswhitfield@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Full-stack leaning, four years; backend Python is a part of the role, not the core.

SKILLS

JavaScript · Python · Node.js · PostgreSQL · AWS · React

EXPERIENCE

Agency, Full-stack Engineer

2020 – present

- Builds React front-ends and some Python/Node APIs.
- Backend is maybe a third of the work.

EDUCATION

BSc CS, University of Texas, 2020

Divya Pillai

Backend Engineer

Thiruvananthapuram, IN · divyapillai@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Three years Python; strong on databases, cloud is only just starting.

SKILLS

Python • Flask • PostgreSQL • REST

EXPERIENCE

Product company, Backend Engineer

2021 – present

- Owns reporting APIs in Flask + PostgreSQL.
- Optimised slow queries; no cloud ownership yet.

EDUCATION

B.Tech CS, CET Trivandrum, 2021

Liam O'Brien

Frontend Engineer

Dublin, IE · liamobrien@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Five years front-end. Deep React, minimal backend Python.

SKILLS

JavaScript · TypeScript · React · CSS · Node.js

EXPERIENCE

Product company, Frontend Engineer

2019 – present

- Owns the web front-end in React.
- Touches Node APIs occasionally; no Python.

EDUCATION

BSc CS, Trinity College Dublin, 2019

Sneha Deshpande

QA Automation Engineer

Nagpur, IN · snehadeshpande@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Four years in test automation, writes Python for tests, not backend services.

SKILLS

Python • Selenium • Pytest • SQL • REST

EXPERIENCE

Services firm, QA Automation

2020 – present

- Writes Python test suites (Selenium, Pytest).
- Tests REST APIs but does not build them.

EDUCATION

B.E. CSE, RCOEM Nagpur, 2020

Yuki Tanaka

Data Analyst

Tokyo, JP · yukitanaka@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Three years in analytics. Python for data, not for building services.

SKILLS

Python · Pandas · SQL · Tableau

EXPERIENCE

Retail company, Data Analyst

2021 – present

- Analyses sales data in Python and SQL.
- Builds dashboards; no API or backend work.

EDUCATION

BA Economics, Keio University, 2021

Omar Haddad

DevOps Engineer

Amman, JO · omarhaddad@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Five years DevOps and cloud. Strong AWS, scripts in Python, does not build product APIs.

SKILLS

AWS · Terraform · Docker · Kubernetes · Python · Bash

EXPERIENCE

Cloud consultancy, DevOps Engineer

2019 – present

- Runs AWS infrastructure and CI/CD.
- Python for automation, not backend services.

EDUCATION

BSc CS, University of Jordan, 2018

Grace Mwangi

Junior Backend Engineer

Nairobi, KE · gracemwangi@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Career-changer from teaching. One year of Python backend after an intensive bootcamp; fast learner, strong projects.

SKILLS

Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · REST · Docker

EXPERIENCE

Fintech startup, Junior Backend Engineer

2024 – present

- Builds and ships small FastAPI services on a cloud host.
- Rebuilt a slow endpoint, cutting response time in half.

Secondary school, Mathematics Teacher

2017 – 2023

- Taught mathematics; switched to software in 2023.

EDUCATION

Software Engineering, Moringa School bootcamp, 2023

Aditya Kulkarni

Principal Engineer

Bengaluru, IN · adityakulkarni@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Twelve years, deep Python and architecture. Very senior; likely over-qualified and expensive for this role.

SKILLS

Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · AWS · Kafka · Kubernetes · REST

EXPERIENCE

Large product company, Principal Engineer

2016 – present

- Sets backend architecture across teams.
- Owns platform reliability at very large scale.
- Mostly leads now; less hands-on coding.

Earlier roles, Engineer to Staff

2011 – 2016

- Hands-on Python backend across several companies.

EDUCATION

M.Tech CSE, IIT Bombay, 2011

Hannah Schmidt

Backend Engineer

Berlin, DE · hannahschmidt@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

Clearly strong Python and cloud, but the resume gives almost no dates or tenure detail.

SKILLS

Python • Django • PostgreSQL • AWS • REST • Docker

EXPERIENCE

Fintech company, Backend Engineer

dates not listed

- Owns several payment APIs in Django on AWS.
- Reduced error rates on a core service.
- Tenure and start dates are not stated on the resume.

EDUCATION

BSc CS, TU Berlin

Arjun Menon

Self-taught Backend Developer

Remote, IN · arjunmenon@email.com · +00 00000 00000

SUMMARY

No formal CS degree. Self-taught, three years of strong open-source and freelance Python APIs.

SKILLS

Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · AWS · REST · Docker

EXPERIENCE

Freelance / open-source, Backend Developer

2021 – present

- Ships FastAPI services for clients on AWS.
- Maintains a popular open-source Python API library (2k+ stars).
- Strong portfolio; non-traditional background.

EDUCATION

No formal degree; self-taught